

REVIEW



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Trusts No One

MATT EICH FOR WSJ

WSJ

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL WEEKEND

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What's
News

Business & Finance

◆ **Volkswagen set out** a proposal to invest in the U.S. in exchange for concessions on tariffs, a move that came as it reported a sharp fall in first-half earnings. **B9**

◆ **Meta said it would stop** political adverts being displayed on its social networks in the EU from October, citing a law designed to tackle misinformation and foreign interference in elections. **B9**

◆ **The S&P 500** hit a record Friday for the ninth time this month while the Nasdaq posted its 13th high for July. For the week, the S&P 500 rose 1.5% while the Nasdaq and Dow gained 1% and 1.3%, respectively. **B11**

◆ **CME Group prevailed** in a legal battle when a jury ruled the exchange giant didn't break its contract with former floor traders when it pivoted to electronic markets. **B11**

◆ **Charter Communications** logged lower-than-expected earnings and tepid revenue growth, sparking a selloff. **B10**

◆ **Health insurer Centene** swung to a loss in the second quarter and offered a drastically reduced projection for full-year earnings. **B10**

◆ **HCA Healthcare raised** its full-year guidance for earnings and sales as both figures exceeded analyst targets for the second quarter. **B10**

World- Wide

◆ **The White House** is seeking fines from several universities it says failed to stop antisemitism on campus in exchange for allowing the schools to access federal funding, according to a person familiar with the matter. **A1**

◆ **The Democratic Party's** image has eroded to its lowest point in more than three decades, according to a new Wall Street Journal poll. **A1**

◆ **HHS Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr.** plans to remove all the members of an advisory panel that determines what preventive health measures insurers must cover, people familiar with the matter said. **A3**

◆ **A federal judge** dismissed the Trump administration's lawsuit against Illinois and Chicago over sanctuary policies that the government has said interfere with immigration enforcement. **A2**

◆ **Israel has emerged** from a string of stunning military successes with nearly unchecked power in the Middle East, leaving Washington struggling to adjust. **A6**

◆ **The leaders of Britain, France and Germany** demanded Israel allow aid into Gaza to end a "humanitarian catastrophe." **A8**

◆ **Thai and Cambodian** forces traded heavy fire across parts of their 500-mile border for a second day. **A6**

NOONAN

Trump never says 'no' to a fight, fight, fight **A13**

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Civilians Seek Safety as Thailand, Cambodia Clash



KEEPING FAITH: A Buddhist monk takes shelter in Thailand's Surin province Friday as Thai and Cambodian forces traded heavy fire across the border, prompting more than 100,000 people to flee. For a video on the deadly conflict, scan the code on **A6**.

Japan Gives \$550 Billion Boost To Trump Sovereign-Fund Wish

President Trump has long wanted a U.S. sovereign-wealth fund that would give him free rein to make big in-

By Gavin Bade,
Corrie Driebusch
and Peter Rudegeair

vestments in key sectors. Japan is poised to help him get the next best thing. As part of a trade deal reached this past week, Japan

agreed to invest \$550 billion in projects across strategic U.S. industries, including energy, semiconductor manufacturing and shipbuilding. The White House said Trump would have final say over where the money goes and that the U.S. would keep 90% of profits on any investments. One Trump official said the administration was thinking of the arrangement like a sovereign-wealth fund that Japan

is funding. The money will take the form of equity, loans and loan guarantees and come from the Japanese government, not private companies, said Sen. Bill Hagerty (R., Tenn.), who met Thursday with a Japanese delegation. He said the deal doesn't include any private-sector commitments already made, such as the Japanese investment-firm SoftBank's pledge to back

an up-to \$500 billion artificial-intelligence project known as "Stargate." "This is separate from all of that," said Hagerty, who served as ambassador to Japan in Trump's first term. "This is a Japanese government commitment." If the fund materializes as *Please turn to page A2*

◆ **Hopes rise for Europe trade deal with U.S.** **A2**

Democrats At 35-Year Low, WSJ Poll Finds

By Aaron Zitner

The Democratic Party's image has eroded to its lowest point in more than three decades, according to a new Wall Street Journal poll, with voters seeing Republicans as better at handling most issues that decide elections. The new survey finds that 63% of voters hold an unfavorable view of the Democratic Party—the highest share in Journal polls dating to 1990 and 30 points higher than the 33% who hold a favorable view. That is a far weaker assessment than voters give to either President Trump or the Republican Party; both are viewed more unfavorably than favorably by 7 points and 11 points, respectively. A mere 8% of voters view the Democrats "very favorably," compared with 19% who show that level of enthusiasm for the GOP. Democrats have been hoping that a voter backlash against the GOP president will be powerful enough to restore their majority in the House in next year's elections, much as it did during Trump's first term. But the Journal poll suggests that the party hasn't yet accomplished a needed first step in that plan: Persuading voters they can do a *Please turn to page A4*

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◆ **Hunter Biden blasts Democrats.....** **A4**

EXCHANGE



CRYPTO CRAZE
Companies are spending billions on a wild new cryptocurrency trade. **B1**

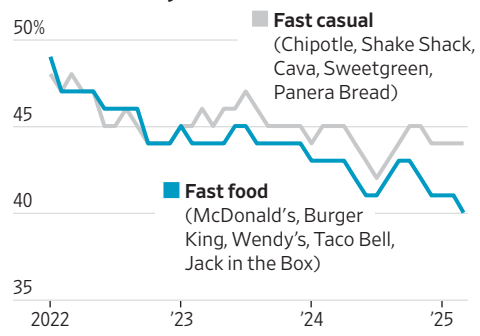
How McDonald's Lost Its Value Edge

The chain that staked its name on affordability found itself on the wrong end of a shaky economy. It's clawing its way back.

By Heather Haddon

When Americans hit hard times, McDonald's has relied on a simple recipe to keep sales humming: being fast and cheap. For many people these days, McDonald's is just fast. "Bro what happened to McDonald's dollar menu?!!!" a Seattle woman asked on TikTok earlier this year, sharing images of a \$12 McDougle meal and \$3 fries. The once-golden formula faltered. The number of fast-food customers who said the restaurant chain offered good value fell to its lowest point in a decade last year, according *Please turn to page A9*

Value for money



Note: Three-month rolling average of answers of 'above average'
Source: TD Cowen consumer tracker of about 2,500 U.S. customers

In This Brand of Parenting, Mom and Dad Bite Back

Gentle approach that's dominated culture gives way to FAFO; 'out-feral their feral'

By Ellen Gamerman

Carla Dillon tried lots of ways to discipline her rambunctious 13-year-old, including making him write the same contrite sentence 100 times. But when he sprayed her with a water gun at a campground after she asked him not to, she saw only one option: She threw him in the pond, clothes and all. "Some of the best lessons in life are the hard ones," she said. *Please turn to page A9*

The internet calls it "FAFO," short for "F—Around and Find Out." It's a child-rearing style that elevates consequences over the "gentle parenting" methods that have helped shape Gen Z. FAFO (often pronounced "faff-oh") is based on the idea that parents can ask and warn, but if a child breaks the rules, mom and dad aren't standing in the way of the repercussions. Won't bring your raincoat? Walk home in the *Please turn to page A9*

Books in English Class Shift Little in Decades

By Sara Randazzo

Teenagers in English classrooms today in many ways seem a world apart from students decades ago. The books sitting on their desks, however, are remarkably similar. Classics including Shakespeare plays, F. Scott Fitzgerald's "The Great Gatsby" and Arthur Miller's "The Crucible" all appear in the top 10 books assigned by English teachers at public middle and high schools today, according to a new report. Six of the top 10—John Steinbeck's "Of Mice and Men" and "Hamlet" among

White House Targets More Colleges

After Columbia deal, Trump administration is seeking fines from other universities

The White House is seeking fines from several universities it says failed to stop antisemitism on campus, including hundreds of millions of dollars from Harvard University, in exchange for allowing the schools to access federal funding, according to a person familiar with the matter.

By Natalie Andrews,
Douglas Belkin and
Sara Randazzo

The deal that the Trump administration struck with Columbia University on Wednesday is now a blueprint for negotiations with other universities, a White House official said. Columbia agreed to pay \$200 million to the federal government over three years to settle allegations it violated antidiscrimination law and to restore its federal grants. The administration is in talks with several universities, including Cornell, Duke, Northwestern and Brown, the person familiar with the talks said, though it sees striking a deal with Harvard as a key target. The White House hopes to extract hundreds of millions of dollars from Harvard, in a deal that would make Columbia's \$200 million payment look like peanuts, the person said. Harvard declined to comment. It has pursued a different strategy from Columbia *Please turn to page A4*